

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 22, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Jonah 1:17–2:10

1:17 Now the Lord had prepared a great fish to swallow Jonah. And Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights.

2:1 Then Jonah prayed to the Lord his God from the fish's belly.

2:2 And he said: "I cried out to the Lord because of my affliction, And He answered me. Out of the belly of Sheol I cried, And You heard my voice.

2:3 For You cast me into the deep, Into the heart of the seas, And the floods surrounded me; All Your billows and Your waves passed over me.

2:4 Then I said, 'I have been cast out of Your sight; Yet I will look again toward Your holy temple.'

2:5 The waters surrounded me, even to my soul; The deep closed around me; Weeds were wrapped around my head.

2:6 I went down to the moorings of the mountains; The earth with its bars closed behind me forever; Yet You have brought up my life from the pit, O Lord, my God.

2:7 When my soul fainted within me, I remembered the Lord; And my prayer went up to You, Into Your holy temple.

2:8 Those who regard worthless idols Forsake their own Mercy.

2:9 But I will sacrifice to You With the voice of thanksgiving; I will pay what I have vowed. Salvation is of the Lord."

2:10 So the Lord spoke to the fish, and it vomited Jonah onto dry land.

II. Key Summary

- The Lord prepared a great fish to swallow Jonah, and Jonah spent three days and

three nights in its belly.

- Jonah prayed to God from inside the fish, describing his cry from the depths and God's faithful response in hearing his voice.
 - Jonah's prayer ends with the declaration "Salvation is of the Lord," a renewed vow to obey, and God's command for the fish to release him onto dry land.
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III. Passage Analysis

Even in the Darkest Place, the Heart Can Still Turn to God

"Jonah's greatest pain was not the calamity, but his separation from God — his feeling that he was cast out of Your sight. Still, he was determined — even in the belly of a fish — to turn his heart towards God and His temple." [1]

Jonah prayed where there was no light, no way out, and no guarantee he'd survive. Yet he opened his mouth — and God heard him. This passage shows us that calling out to God doesn't require favorable conditions. Even from the most hopeless place, prayer still reaches Him.

"Salvation Is of the Lord" — Giving Thanks Before the Answer Comes

"Jonah demonstrates undisturbed faith in God's mercy while in the fish's belly, secure that divine deliverance would follow — offering praise before any way out appeared." [2]

Jonah's prayer reads more like a song of gratitude than a desperate plea. He declared "Salvation is of the Lord" before he was rescued — because he knew God's character. That kind of steadiness isn't wishful thinking; it's grounded in knowing who God is.

IV. Reflection Question

Has there been a time when you felt like everything was falling apart and there was no way forward — did you reach out to God, or did you go quiet?

Jonah cried out from the darkest place imaginable, and God heard him. This passage is saying that your situation is also within range of what God can hear.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/jonah-2/>

[2] BibleHub.com, Barnes' Notes / Keil and Delitzsch,
<https://biblehub.com/commentaries/jonah/2-1.htm>